

What it Takes to be an Adept Android Apps Developer!

In recent years, the Android platform has turned out some cool developers, in India and across the world, who have the ability to think out-of-the-box and create apps within no time. So, if you have the right skill sets and mindset, a career in Android app development can be exceptionally rewarding.



The increasing popularity of the Android platform has given an incredible boost to the app economy in India.

The app market in India witnesses nearly 100 million downloads a month and this is expected to grow exponentially in the days to come. The rise in the app economy as well as the growing penetration of the Android ecosystem in India has led to the explosion in app development. This has opened up a sea of job opportunities for all those who wish to take the plunge in this terrain.

Highlighting the importance of Android apps developers in the Indian market, Sachin Naik, head, Product Development, Xolo, says, "Content consumption and data aggregation over smartphones is the new mantra. And Indian IT companies are building engineering capacity to support this endeavour. This provides a very big opportunity in terms of the number of job openings, especially at the entry level, for prospective Android apps developers. Globally, India is one among the top 10 countries in terms of app submissions to the Play store. There is a strong ecosystem of start-ups like Flipkart, Scandid, etc—companies that have adopted and are building mobile applications. This provides a good opportunity for senior app developers who are aspiring to take up challenging roles. Apart from these, there are opportunities with mobile chip set makers and OEMs like Qualcomm, NVidia, Intel and Samsung. Most of the above have a good engineering presence in India and are expanding rapidly."

Why Android apps development?

We caught up with a few cool and geeky Android developers and asked them to share their experiences on how and why they chose this domain as a career option. Amrit Sanjeev is the organiser for *Bldrroid* (Bangalore Android user group) and the author of the news reader application *Paperboy*. Amrit, who currently works at Digital Insight as staff engineer, Mobile, was working at IBM as a technology architect when Android was released. "I thought that Android was an interesting OS to explore. There was some overlap with areas that I was working in at college, which involved the Linux kernel. And the open source nature of the OS made me gravitate towards exploring Android further. But I didn't really start off as an Android apps developer. I was more interested in working on the OS," he shares.

Vinod Kumar Desu, lead engineer at Samsung Research India, has over five years of experience in Android applications and framework development, debugging, problem analysis and porting on various Samsung Android-based handsets. He shares, "Initially, I started as a J2me mobile developer. My interest in new technologies on the mobile domain led me to explore the world of Android development and I am happy being here."

Pooja Maheshwari, a technical architect at Impetus Technology, has been working in the software domain for more than 12 years, with wide exposure in the analysis, design